built, it was the second-longest tunnel in the Indian Railways and is still among the longest tunnels in India. Its construction started in July 1900 and was completed in September 1903. It is a straight tunnel and also the longest straight stretch on KSR. Its construction posed numerous engineering challenges as it passed through fissured sandstone rocks.

Originally, a 2-km-long tunnel was planned under the charge of Colonel Barog. Tunneling was started from both ends but due to misalignment, the project had to be abandoned. The government fined him ₹1 and this failure made him so ashamed that he shot himself. Barog station is named after him. The old tunnel and the grave of this great engineer are still there, just a kilometre from the present tunnel. This tunnel was finally constructed under Chief Engineer H.S. Herilngton at a cost of ₹0.84 million. Herlington also faced similar problems in finding proper alignment of the railway track. It is believed that Baba Bhalkhu, a local saint from Jhaja, near Chail, who possessed supernatural engineering skills, helped the British engineers lay this track .

According to the *Simla Gazette* , the viceroy of the British government presented Baba Bhalku with a medal and a turban to show appreciation and respect. The Baba Bhalku Rail Museum was opened to the public by the general manager of the Northern Railway on 7 July 2011 in commemoration of the service provided by Baba Bhalku in guiding engineers for the construction of this line. Many interesting artefacts of the KSR section having heritage value, from delicate vintage crockery to bulky iron bells and weighing machines, are displayed there. [85]

Tunnel No. 33 on the line was given Colonel Barog’s name as a mark of respect to him. It is said that the friendly ghost of Barog can still be seen around the abandoned tunnel. At the latest count, there are five legends around it.

The Barog tunnel story gets more mysterious if we go by the legends. We have all heard of tales in which someone dies in a place and then haunts it forever. But besides the story of Colonel Barog’s ghost haunting the tunnel, there are four more tales of haunting associated with it.

One is of a werewolf. It is said that the tunnel could not be completed due to animal attacks. Barog, along with a hunting party, set out one night to hunt down the animal but what they found that night was beyond anyone’s belief. Barog was the only survivor and described the attacker as